

Andy young at heart with two pupils in Series

To be seventy years young is sometimes far more cheerful and hopeful than to be 40 years old.

—Oliver Wendell Holmes



John Laird
Times Sports Editor

ANDY COHEN will turn 75 Oct. 26 "if I'm still around" and he no longer manages a baseball team "because I can't swing a fungo bat anymore" and he can't work fulltime "because I don't see so good these days."

Come to think of it, any man who claims to have managed both World Series managers, who aren't spring chickens themselves, must have been around a long time.

But, waste no pity on Andy Cohen. He may be well enough along in years to remember when you bought \$5 worth of groceries and had to hold the bag from the bottom, but Andy's not old.

Maybe he scans the menu before scanning the waitress, but Andy's not old.

Even if he DID attend El Paso High School when it was THE El Paso high school, Andy's not old.

You want old? I'll give you old. The World Series. Now that's old. Seventy-six years old, to be exact, but even if he's 75, Andy's not old.

Old, really old, is complaining about the good ol' days while doing 70 in an air-conditioned Mark IV. I know some 50-year-olds who are that old.

Old, really old, is wishing your wife would only rock the cradle instead of the

boat. I know some 30-year-olds that are that old.

But, Andy's not old. Back in July, Andy was trotting from the El Paso Diablo dugout to the first base coaching box when some drunk bellowed out from behind home plate, "Hey, let's move along there, you ol' pioneer." I could've backhanded the idiot.

I knew Andy was still light years from senility when I saw the venerable veteran look over at the antagonist and smile gently as if to say, "I haven't grown old, I've grown up, which puts me a step ahead of you."

Andy might have been better off as a warrior for some Oriental tribe. I hear the Orientals are big on respect for the elderly. Papa San Cohen deserves that kind of respect.

Only recently has the aging baseball manager started cashing his chips at the Oldtimers' Fun Table. After leaving UTEP's baseball coaching position with a very, very losing record of 17 years, Andy spent an enjoyable summer with the Diablos, "working with some of the finest young men I've ever known."

And now, appropriately, Andy is about to

experience the most exciting, and surely the most deserved, reward since 1911 when he first caught one of his father's pop-ups. Not even playing in a men's league as a 14-year-old could have compared with the upcoming, ultimate dividend.

When Baltimore's Earl Weaver and Pittsburgh's Chuck Tanner match their strategic skills in the upcoming championship playoff, Cohen will have the rare honor of watching two men whom he managed . . . manage in the World Series.

Andy guided Chuck Tanner back when Reggie Jackson was in diapers, in 1948 at Class C Eau Claire, Wisc. This, mind you, was before either one of the starters in today's Series opener was born.

In 1965, when Tanner came to El Paso as a manager himself, Andy was on hand to help the locals win a Texas League pennant.

Andy had Earl Weaver as a feisty second baseman on the Denver squad in 1954. "That was when I first saw Earl Weaver scoop up dirt and pile it on home plate when he was arguing with an umpire. He still does that, doesn't he?" Andy asked Monday.

In 1955, Andy talked management into letting him take Weaver with him to New Orleans. "I knew Earl wasn't a major league prospect, but I wanted him because he was such a team leader. Guess who I turned down to keep Earl? Bill Mazerowski, one of the greatest second basemen ever!"

Weaver remembered his old, oops, make that his former manager this week when Andy's daughter called for World Series tickets as a 75th birthday present for Dad. "Tell Andy happy birthday, we're all looking forward to seeing him and two tickets will be waiting for him at the gate," Weaver said.

But, because he couldn't find a place to stay in or around Baltimore, Andy called Weaver and told him the trip was off. "I'll probably be able to see more on TV anyway," Andy rationalized.

After managing the managers, who does Cohen like for the pennant? "Baltimore has the best depth; that's why they beat California three out of four, with California losing Aikens and Rudi to injuries. I like the Orioles, but please don't tell Chuck Tanner."

Whichever man guides the winning team, and no matter how many games are required, Andy will be able to tell the world that he managed the manager of the world's champions.

At one point Monday afternoon, Andy pulled up all serious-like, waxed reflective and said softly, "That, plus my 75th birthday, is what's going to make this my most memorable World Series ever."

And, seizing that kind of excitement from what basically is a little boys' game is what will keep Andy from ever becoming an old man.



ANDY COHEN
... hasn't grown old

Orioles get edge by oddsmakers

RENO, Nev. (AP) — The Baltimore Orioles have an edge over the Pittsburgh Pirates in the World Series, oddsmakers at Harrah's Sports Book in Reno said Monday.

And the Orioles are also favored in Tuesday night's first game in Baltimore by a 5-7 margin.

For the series, the Orioles are listed at 5 to 6½ while the Pirates are 11 to 10 picks.